Private Access (ZPA)

Configuring Access Policies

Access policy rules enable you to implement role-based access control. For a complete list of ranges and limitations for access policy rules, see Ranges & Limitations.

To configure an access policy rule:

1. Go to **Policies** > **Access Control** > **Private Applications** > **Access Policy**.
2. Click **Add Rule**.

   The **Add Access Policy** window appears.

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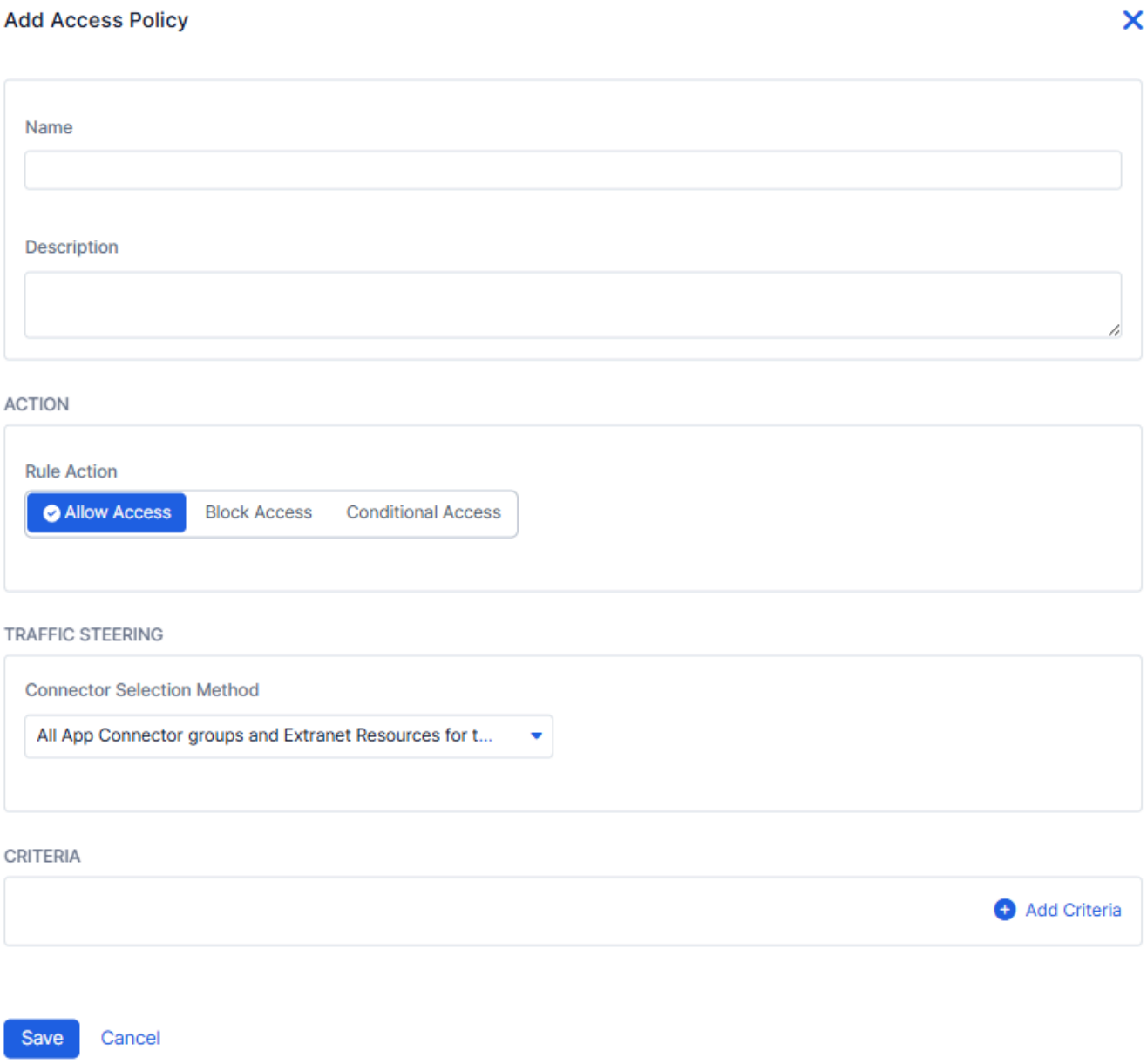

3. In the **Add Access Policy** window:
   - **Name**: Enter an access policy name. The name cannot contain special characters, except for periods (.), hyphens (-), and underscores (_).
   - **Description**: (Optional) Enter a description.
   - For **Action**:
     - **Rule Action**: Select one of the following options:
       - **Allow Access**: Allows access to applications.
       - **Block Access**: Blocks access to applications.

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- **Conditional Access**: Allows access to sensitive resources for step-up authentication, and is only an option if you are subscribed to ZIdentity. Step-up authentication enforces stronger authentication and only provides access to applications when the authentication matches the additional authentication levels. The **Allow with Privileged Approval** checkbox is only an option if you have Privileged Remote Access (PRA) and is primarily targeted for PRA-enabled application segments. Contact Zscaler Support for more information. Click the **Step-Up Authentication Level** checkbox to select an authentication level from the drop-down menu. The authentication levels must be configured in the Zscaler Admin Console. If a user is not at the defined authentication level, they are prompted to reinforce their authentication level. If the authentication level matches, then the user can access their resources. If you try to access an application that requires additional authentication, Zscaler Client Connector displays a pop-up notification prompting you to verify your access. To learn more, see Verifying Access to Applications and Understanding Step-Up Authentication.

> By default, Private Access (ZPA) blocks access to applications and segment groups for users until you configure policy rules that explicitly allow access. So, you only need to configure policy rules to block access for specific circumstances or to require approval. For example, if you want to allow access to all applications in your organization for most users but block access for some users, you can configure one policy rule that blocks access for those specific users while another rule allows access to all other users. Private Access uses a first-match principle when evaluating policies, so for this scenario, you must list the block rule before the allow rule. To learn more, see Policy Evaluation Order. For more on use cases that call for policy rules that block access, see Access Policy Configuration Examples.

- **Pop-Up Message to User**: (Optional) Enable to enter the message you want to display to users with blocked access. Zscaler recommends that you include helpful information so users understand why they are being denied access.

> This field is only visible if **Rule Action** is set to **Block Access**. This setting only affects the behavior of the pop-up notification for the end user. A notification is still received in the Notifications window of Zscaler Client Connector. This feature is only supported for Zscaler Client Connector version 4.7 for Windows.

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- For **Traffic Steering**, under **App Connector Selection Method**: Select **All App Connector groups for the application** or **Specific App Connector or Server groups for the application**.

  > **Extranet Resources** appears in these options if your organization has the Extranet Application Support feature enabled.

  - **Connector Type**: If you select **Specific App Connector or Server groups for the application**, choose a connector option:
    - Select **App Connector**, and then choose which App Connector groups, server groups, or a mixture of both you want the access policy to use.

      > The maximum limit of selected App Connector groups is 48. If **All App Connector groups for the application** is selected and there are more than 48 configured for your organization, then only 48 App Connector groups are used. This limit applies to newly created or edited policy rules after March 4, 2024.

    - Select **Extranet**, and then choose a partner, location group, and/or location you want the access policy to use.

      > There is a maximum of 10 location groups and 50 locations per policy for extranet. Additionally, some features in application segments are not available for extranet. To learn more, see Configuring Defined Application Segments.

- For **Criteria**, click **Add Criteria** to add any of the available criteria types. The drop-down menu only displays criteria that are not already in use by the rule, except for **Client Connector Posture Profile** condition sets. You can add up to 10 condition sets.

  Applications

  Choose the application segments and segment groups to which this rule applies:

  - **Application Segments**: Choose the application segments, and click **Done**. You can search for a specific application segment, click **Select All** to apply all applications segments, or click **Clear Selection** to remove all selections. The application segments you've configured appear in the menu. There is no limit to the number you can select.

    If you added multiple application segments to the policy rule, Private Access uses an OR Boolean operator between them.

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There are limits to the number of application segments applied to a rule. For a complete list of ranges and limitations for Access Policy rules, see Ranges & Limitations.

- **Segment Groups**: Choose the segment groups, and click **Done**. You can search for a specific segment group, click **Select All** to apply all segment groups, or click **Clear Selection** to remove all selections. The segment groups you've configured appear in the menu. There is no limit to the number you can select.
  If you added multiple segment groups to the policy rule, Private Access uses an OR Boolean operator between them.

Branch Connector Groups

Choose the Branch Connector groups to which the rule applies. You can search for a specific Branch Connector group, click **Select All Displayed** to apply all Branch Connector groups, or click **Clear All** to remove all selections.

Chrome Enterprise Browser

Enable **Chrome Enterprise Browser** to verify users that are accessing private applications via the Chrome Enterprise browser.

Make sure you have configured Chrome Enterprise Browser Connector settings to allow the Chrome Enterprise browser to integrate with Private Access.

When enabled, you can also select a configured Chrome posture profile to evaluate criteria for access to private applications.

Client Connector Posture Profiles

Choose the condition sets to which the rule applies. You can add up to 10 **Client Connector Posture Profile** condition sets to the rule. Click **Add Criteria** to include additional sets.

Each condition set can contain multiple posture profiles to enforce on a user's device. For each profile, select one of the following:

- **VERIFIED**: Zscaler Client Connector verified the user's device against the criteria specified in the posture profile.
- **VERIFICATION FAILED**: Zscaler Client Connector was unable to verify the user's device against the criteria specified in the posture profile.

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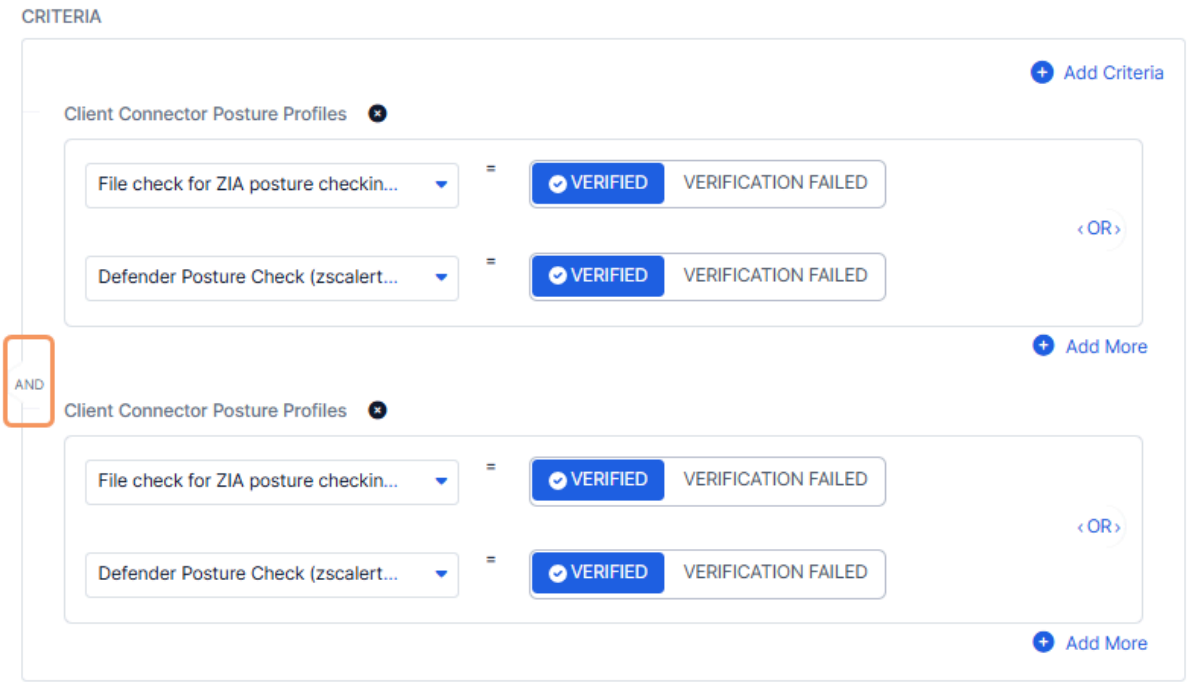
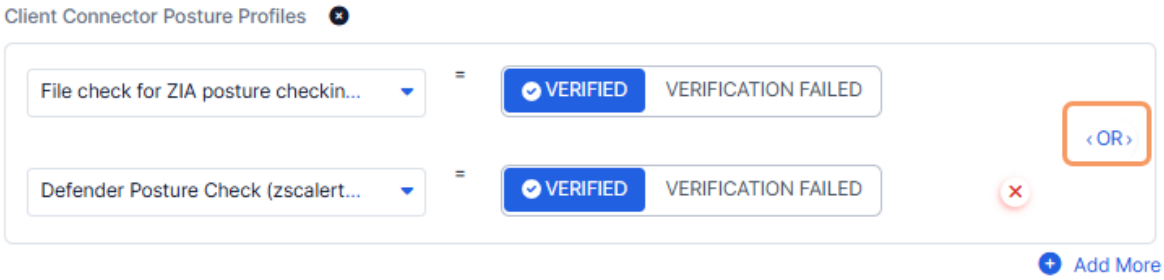
Make sure you have configured the posture profiles within the Zscaler Client Connector Portal. The posture profiles you configure in the Zscaler Client Connector Portal appear in the drop-down menu, where you can search for a specific profile.

If you added multiple posture profile condition sets to the policy rule, Private Access uses an AND Boolean operator between them. Private Access evaluates each posture profile condition set individually.



If you added multiple posture profiles within a posture profile condition set, Private Access uses an OR Boolean operator between them by default. However, you can toggle this to an AND operator by clicking on it.



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When selecting client types from **Client Connector Posture Profiles**, you can select one client type. Private Access uses an OR Boolean operator to join them together.

> You must select a **Client Connector Posture Profile** prior to selecting a client type.

Client Connector Trusted Networks

Choose the trusted networks to which the rule applies, and click **Done**. You can search for a specific trusted network, click **Select All** to have the rule apply to all trusted networks, or click **Clear Selection** to remove all selections. The trusted networks you've configured appear in the menu. There is no limit to the number you can select.

A forwarding profile tells Zscaler Client Connector how to treat traffic from your users' systems in different network environments for Private Access. When a user connects to a network, Zscaler Client Connector checks to determine what type of network the user is connected to.

If you added multiple trusted networks to the policy rule, Private Access uses an OR Boolean operator between them.

Make sure you have configured your Trusted Network Criteria within the Zscaler Client Connector Portal. The trusted networks you configure in the Zscaler Client Connector Portal appear in the drop-down menu.

Client Types

Choose the client types to which the rule applies, and click **Done**. You can search for a specific client type, click **Select All** to apply all client types, or click **Clear Selection** to remove all selections. The valid client types are:

- **Branch Connector**: To learn more, see About Branch Connectors.
- **Client Connector**: To learn more, see What Is Zscaler Client Connector?
- **Client Connector for VDI**: To learn more, see What Is Zscaler Client Connector for VDI?
- **Client Connector Partner**: To learn more, see About Partner Devices.
- **Cloud Browser**: To learn more, see What Is Isolation?
- **Cloud Connector**: To learn more, see About Cloud Connectors.
- **Extranet**: To learn more, see About Extranet.

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- **Machine Tunnel**: To learn more, see About Machine Tunnels.

  > Access policies can be configured with posture profile criteria for the client type machine tunnel if your end user device has Zscaler Client Connector version 3.9 or later installed.

- **Web Browser**: To learn more, see About Browser Access.
- **ZIA Service Edge**: To learn more, see Understanding Source IP Anchoring.

If you added multiple client types to the policy rule, Private Access uses an OR Boolean operator between them.

> Rules using the **Web Browser** or Internet & SaaS **Service Edge** client types additionally can't use posture profiles or trusted networks criteria. The posture profiles or trusted networks criteria only work with **Client Connector**.

Cloud Connector Groups

> The Cloud Connector Group criteria type cannot be configured with the SAML and SCIM Attributes criteria type.

Choose the Cloud Connector groups to which the policy applies, and click **Done**. You can search for a specific Cloud Connector group, click **Select All** to apply all Cloud Connector groups, or click **Clear Selection** to remove all selections. The Cloud Connector groups you've configured appear in the menu. There is no limit to the number you can select.

If you've added multiple Cloud Connector groups to the policy rule, Private Access uses an AND Boolean operator between them.

Country Codes

Choose the countries to which this rule applies. You can search for a specific country, click **Select All** to apply the countries listed, click **Clear All** to remove all selections, or click the **Delete** icon to the right of a selected country to remove it from your list. There is no limit to the number you can select. Click **Cancel** to exit the Country Code menu.

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The Country Codes criteria type is not supported in Browser Access or Privileged Remote Access Applications.

Extranet Location

Choose the extranet resource, extranet locations, and extranet location groups to which the policy rule applies. Extranet resources leverage the Zscaler Internet Access (ZIA) cloud for partner onboarding, IPSec, and location management. Extranet resources can be designated in Private Access when configuring server groups and application segments. To learn more, see About Extranet and Understanding Extranet Application Support.

To use Extranet Location criteria:

a. Select a resource from the **Extranet Resource** drop-down menu. You can search for a specific extranet resource, or click the **Delete** icon to the right of a selected resource to remove it.
b. Select a location from the **Extranet Locations** drop-down menu. This field is only visible after an extranet resource is selected. You can search for a specific extranet location, click **Select All Displayed** to apply all selections, click **Clear All** to remove all selections, or click the **Delete** icon to the right of a selected location to remove it from the list of selected locations.
c. Select a group from the **Extranet Location Groups** drop-down menu. This field is only visible after an extranet resource is selected. You can search for a specific extranet group, click **Select All Displayed** to apply all selections, click **Clear All** to remove all selections, or click the **Delete** icon to the right of a selected group to remove it from the list of selected groups.

The **Extranet Location** criteria is not visible if you are within a Microtenant.

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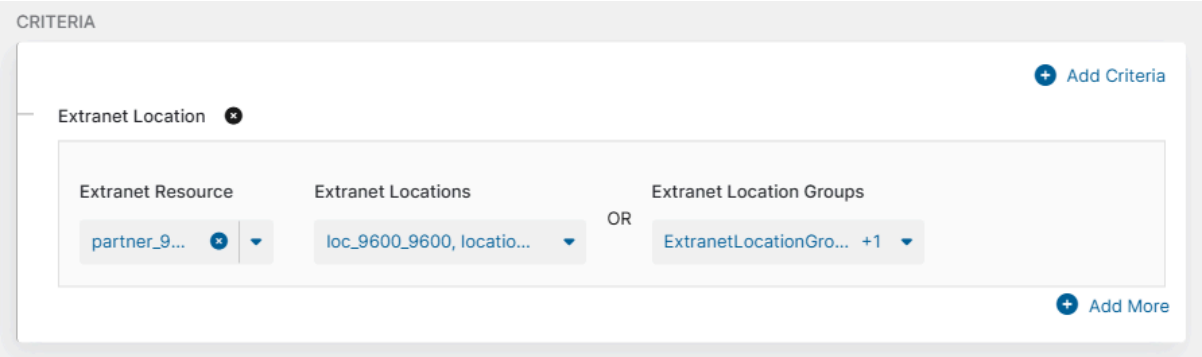
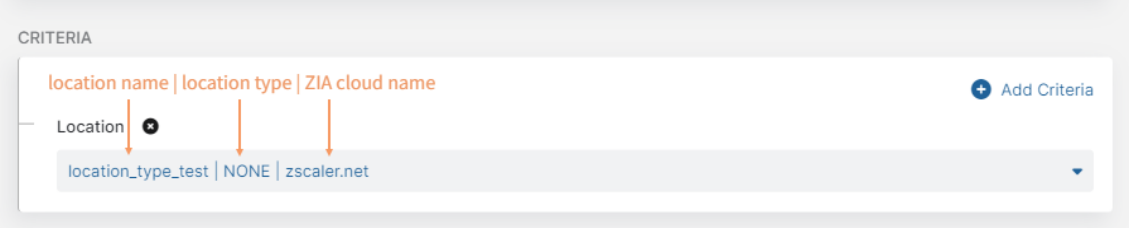


Locations

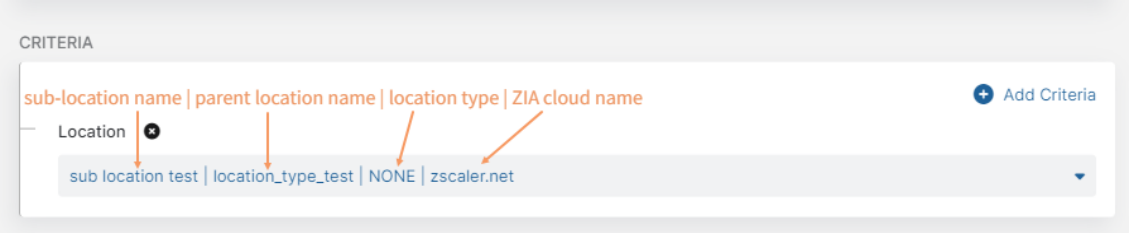
Choose the Branch Connector, Cloud Connector, or other locations and sub-locations to which the rule applies. You can search for a specific Branch Connector, Cloud Connector, or other location, click **Select All Displayed** to apply all locations and sublocations, or click **Clear All** to remove all selections.

Locations and sublocations are displayed in the following format:

- Location without a sublocation:



- Location with a sublocation:



Location types include:

- **BC** - Branch Connector
- **CC** - Cloud Connector
- **NONE** - Locations other than Branch Connector or Cloud Connector. NONE location types are also used in Source IP Anchoring configurations, where traffic is

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routed from these locations to Private Access.

Machine Groups

Choose the Machine groups to which this rule applies, and click **Done**. You can search for a specific Machine group, click **Select All** to apply all groups, or click **Clear Selection** to remove all selections. The Machine groups you've configured appear in the menu. There is no limit to the number you can select.

> If a Machine group is selected, **Machine Tunnel** as a client type is also required.

Platforms

Choose the platforms to which the rule applies and click **Save**. This allows you to control which applications are designated to which devices. The valid platform types are:

- Windows
- macOS
- Linux
- iOS
- Android

If you added multiple platforms to the policy rule, Private Access uses an OR Boolean operator between them.

Risk Scores

Select one or more risk scores and click **Save**. Click **Select All** to apply all the risk scores listed, or **Clear All** to remove all selections. Click **Cancel** to exit the Risk Scores menu.

SAML and SCIM Attributes or Session and User Attributes

> - If you are subscribed to ZIdentity and have this feature enabled for your tenant, the **SAML and SCIM Attributes** criteria is replaced with **Session and User Attributes**. To learn more, see What Is ZIdentity?
> - The SAML and SCIM Attributes criteria type cannot be configured with the Cloud Connector Group criteria type.

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To use SAML or SCIM Criteria:

a. Click **Select IdP** and choose the identity provider (IdP) configuration you want to include in the policy rule. The IdP must be configured for **User** SSO. To learn more, see Configuring an IdP for Single Sign-On. If you need to include multiple IdPs in the policy rule, click **Select IdP** again.
b. Click **Select SAML and SCIM Criteria** to add the criteria to which this rule applies:

SAML Attributes or Session Attributes

By default, the policy rule for **SAML Attributes** is set to **Any SAML attribute**. Keep this if you want to apply the rule action to any user (i.e., the rule applies to all users, groups, departments, etc.).

Alternatively, choose a specific SAML attribute from the drop-down menu if you want to apply the rule action to specific users, groups, departments, etc.:

i. You can search for a specific attribute, select a listed attribute, or click **Clear Selection** to remove all selected attributes.
ii. After you make a selection, enter the SAML attribute value (i.e., the users to whom the rule applies) in the text field that appears.
iii. Click **Add More** to add multiple attributes, if necessary.

> If you are subscribed to ZIdentity and have this feature enabled for your tenant, the **SAML Attributes** option is replaced with **Session Attributes**. The user attributes are populated from the Zscaler Admin Console and are used for defining various sign-on policies. To learn more, see About Attributes and What Is ZIdentity?

SCIM Attributes or User Attributes

Choose a specific SCIM attribute from the drop-down menu to apply the rule action to specific users, groups, departments, etc:

i. You can search for a specific attribute, select a listed attribute, or click **Clear Selection** to remove all selected attributes.
ii. After you make a selection, enter the SCIM attribute value (i.e., the users to whom the rule applies) in the text field that appears.
iii. Click **Add More** to add multiple attributes, if necessary.

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> If you are subscribed to ZIdentity and have this feature enabled for your tenant, the **SCIM Attributes** option is replaced with **User Attributes**. The group attributes are populated from the Zscaler Admin Console and are used for defining various sign-on policies. To learn more, see About Attributes and What Is ZIdentity?

SCIM Groups

Choose a specific SCIM group from the drop-down menu to apply the rule action to a specific group:

i. You can search for a specific group, select a listed group, or click **Clear Selection** to remove all selected groups.
ii. Click **Add More** to add multiple groups, if necessary.

These criteria appear under **SAML and SCIM Attributes** > <IdP Name>, where <IdP Name> is the name of the IdP configuration you selected in step a.

> In order for Private Access to process SAML and SCIM criteria in a rule, you must enable the **SAML Attributes for Policy** setting for SAML and the **SCIM Attributes and Groups for Policy** setting for SCIM when configuring an IdP. To learn more, see Configuring an IdP for Single Sign-On.

If you added multiple attributes or groups to the policy rule, Private Access uses an OR Boolean operator between them by default. For example, if you selected **First Name** and **Last Name**, the policy rule is only applied to users with the specified **First Name** OR **Last Name** for that IdP. However, you can toggle this to an AND operator by clicking on it.

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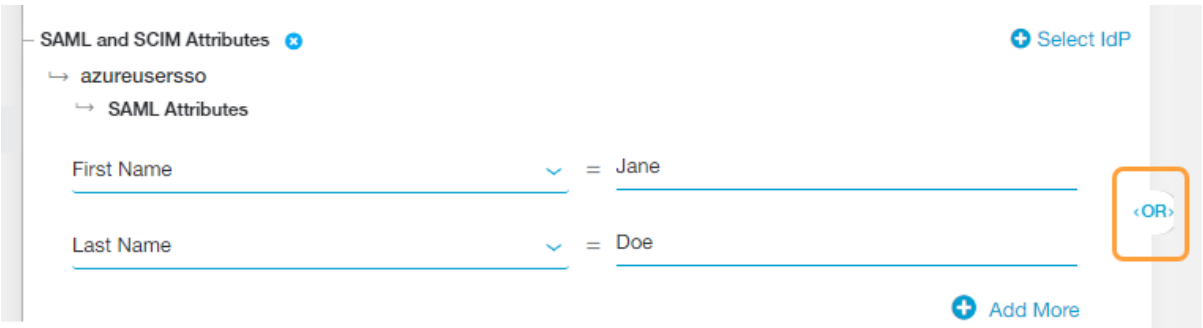

If the corresponding IdP setting (**SAML Attributes for Policy**) is disabled for SAML, but the policy rule has criteria for SAML attributes, Private Access evaluates the rule differently depending on the Boolean operator between the criteria:

- OR: Private Access skips evaluating the criteria for SAML attributes, but continues to evaluate the criteria for SCIM attributes and SCIM groups.
- AND: Private Access does not evaluate this policy rule. You must remove the criteria under SAML Attributes for Private Access to process the policy rule.

If the corresponding IdP setting (**SCIM Attributes and Groups for Policy**) is disabled for SCIM, but the policy rule has criteria for SCIM attributes or SCIM groups, Private Access evaluates the rule differently depending on the Boolean operator between the criteria:

- OR: Private Access skips evaluating the criteria for SCIM attributes and SCIM groups, but continues to evaluate the criteria for SAML attributes.
- AND: Private Access does not evaluate this policy rule. You must remove the criteria for SCIM attributes and SCIM groups for Private Access to process the policy rule.

If you selected multiple IdPs for the policy rule, Private Access uses an OR Boolean operator between them by default. For example, you can select one IdP that includes **First Name** OR **Last Name** and another IdP that includes Any SAML Attribute. In this case, the policy rule applies to a user authenticating from the first IdP if they have the specified **First Name** OR **Last Name** *or* it applies to any user authenticating from the second IdP. However, you can toggle this to an AND operator by clicking on it.

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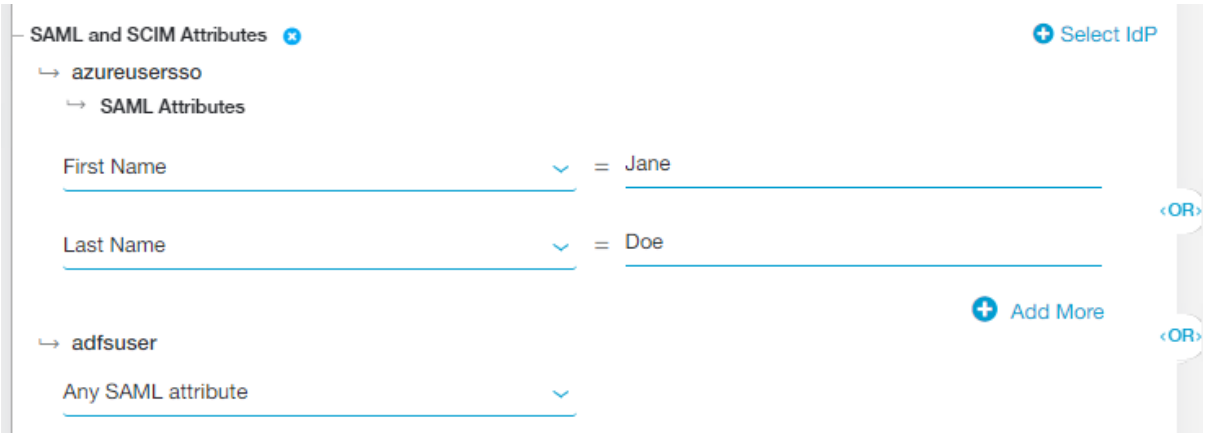

> If your IdP configuration for SSO includes SAML attributes or SCIM attributes from multiple IdPs, Zscaler recommends that you do not use the AND Boolean operator between policy rules.

Workload Groups

> This feature is in limited availability. Contact Zscaler Support to learn more.

Choose a specific workload group from the drop-down menu to apply the rule action to. To learn more, see About Workload Groups.

> If Workload Group is selected, Cloud Connector as a client type is required.

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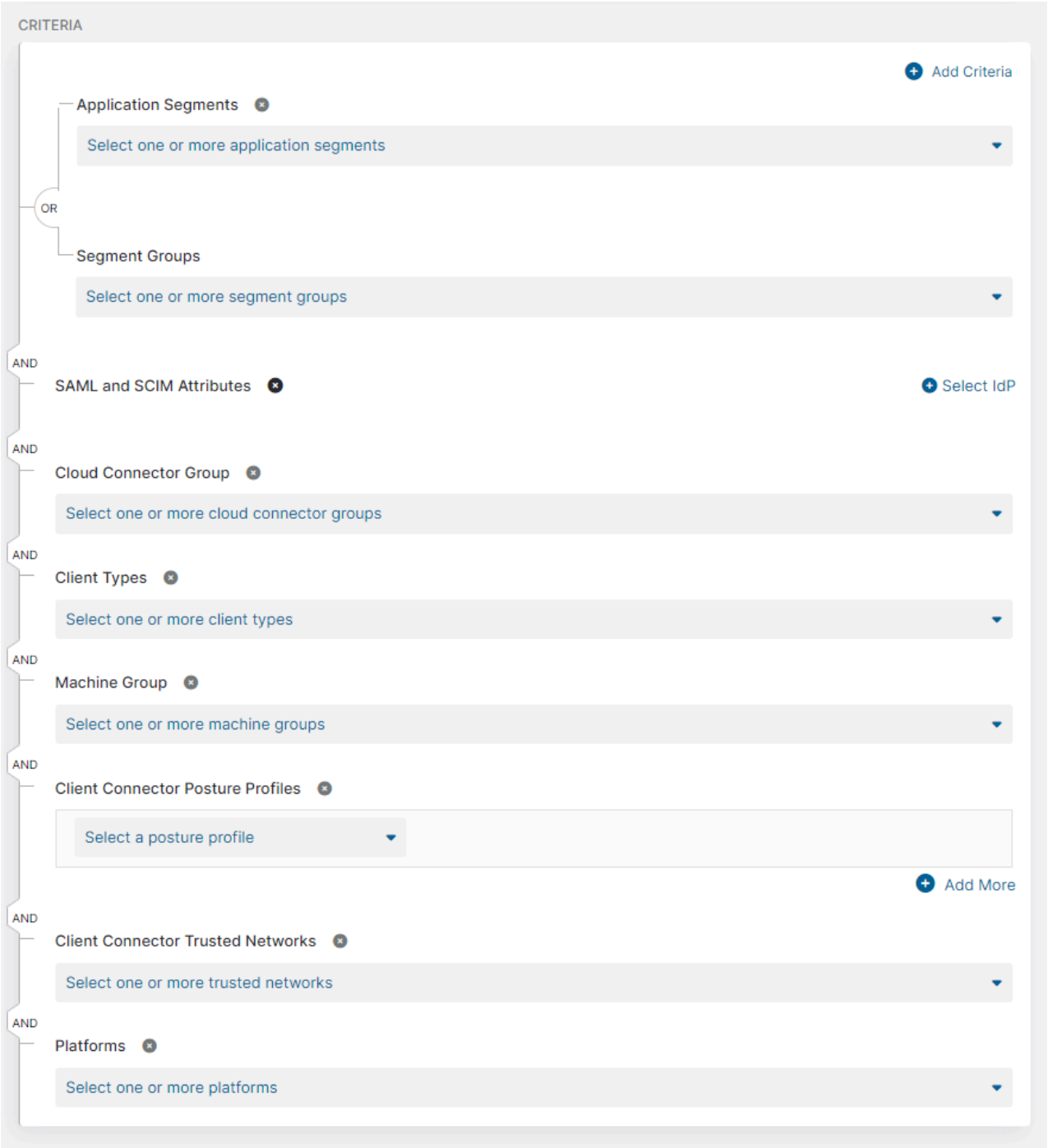

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> The Boolean logic used between **Criteria** is always displayed. For example, when a user requests access to an application, the policy rule is evaluated to check if an application segment OR its segment group are present AND whether any of the SAML attributes are applicable to the user making the request before it grants or denies access. You can always view the **Rule Action** and **Criteria** as well as the applied Boolean logic on the Access Policy page.

4. Click **Save**.

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